

Potato Disease: Late Blight

Metadata

Crop: Potato
Disease: Late Blight
Scientific Name: *Phytophthora infestans*
Pathogen: Oomycete
Source: FAO, ICAR

Overview

Late Blight is a devastating disease of potato causing rapid plant destruction under cool, wet conditions.

Symptoms

Early: Water-soaked spots on leaves.
Advanced: Large brown lesions with white fungal growth under leaves.

Similar Diseases

Early Blight: concentric rings.
Bacterial rot: soft decay.

Favorable Conditions

Cool temperatures (10–20°C), high humidity, prolonged leaf wetness.

Transmission

Spreads through spores via wind and rain, survives in infected tubers.

Management

Cultural: Remove infected plants, ensure drainage.
Chemical: Metalaxyl, mancozeb.

Prevention

Use certified seeds, avoid overhead irrigation, monitor weather.

Severity

Mild: limited lesions.

Severe: rapid plant collapse and crop failure.

Recommended Action

Immediate fungicide application and removal of infected plants.

Source

FAO: <https://www.fao.org>

ICAR: <https://icar.org.in>